

Honours Program at IIIT, Hyderabad (Applicable from UG/DD 2022 batch)

March 2024

Introduction:

Honours is an optional program for 4-yr undergraduate students. For students admitted to the DD program, honours program is mandatory. This is a special program designed to allow bright and motivated students with advanced learning capabilities to participate in research during their undergraduate days. During the Honours project & Summer project(s), students participate in ongoing research activities, taking up the development of innovative ideas, algorithms, prototypes or systems as appropriate for the specific problem. In the entire process, students learn good research practices in thinking, conceptualizing ideas, solving problems, developing systems etc.

At the end of the second year, a student may decide to opt for Honours based on his/her interest. Honours students work with a research center/Honours adviser for two years and two summers. DD students are expected to continue working for their MS thesis in the same centre/advisor.

Four-yr undergraduate students with a CGPA of 8 or more at the end of their second year may join this program. Exceptional and highly motivated students with lower CGPA may also be allowed to join, however, their provisional admission to Honours is confirmed after one semester of project work, (i.e., at the end of 5th semester) based on the recommendation/evaluation of the Honours adviser.

On successful completion, they are awarded a degree: B.Tech (Honours) in CSE/ECE, as the case may be. Honours stream/specializations are available in the major research areas of the institute. Students may contact academic office/program coordinators for the list of streams.

Admission:

- a. Student gives the options/preference one month before the end of 4th semester. Students may plan to contact the faculty members and visit the research centers to know more about the activities.
- b. Selection will be done by the respective centers based on the availability of seats and preference of the students.

Academic Requirements:

- a. The student must complete Honours projects in the 5th, 6th, 7th and 8th semesters, and obtain an average GPA greater than 8 in these four projects. All these projects are of 2-credits each. There is no separate BTP for the Honours students of 4-year B.Tech.

b. In addition to the above, the 4-yr student has to do **summer projects worth of 4 credits** (8 credits in case of Dual-Degree students) in the summers after 2nd, 3rd, (and 4th year in case of DD students) year. Summer projects will be typically done in the research center under the guidance of the Honours adviser. Working on a project in the summer with the Honours adviser as a summer project over two months constitutes a 4-credit summer project. No credits less than 4 are possible. The grade will be pass/fail.

c. UG Honors students are allowed to do summer internships for one summer out of the applicable summers after 2nd or 3rd year, with the consent of the Honours adviser. DD students are allowed to do summer internships for one summer out of the applicable summers after 2nd, 3rd or 4th year with the consent of the Honours adviser.

d. In exceptional circumstances the required summer project credits may be earned during the regular semester subject to the consent of Honours advisor and applicable Overload guidelines.

e. Students who do not have avail of industry internships during summers can earn additional summer project credits. This will be shown in the final transcript and not counted towards graduation requirements.

f. The academic requirements for honours degree are given below:

- For Honours students – 8 Credits from 4 honours projects and 4 credits from one summer project.
- For Dual Degree students – 8 Credits from 4 honours projects and 8 credits from 2 summer projects.
- If a student completes 4 honours projects with a GPA > 8.0 and the required summer project credits with a P grade, then the student is awarded a B.Tech degree with Honours. If the GPA < 6, then the 4-yr UG student has to do a BTP afresh to get a BTech degree without Honours (DD student has to repeat the honours project to improve the Honours projects GPA). If the GPA is between 6 and 8 (both inclusive), then the 4-yr UG and DD student is awarded a B.Tech degree without Honours.

Optional Activities for the Honours Students:

- a. Attend summer/winter schools in the area.
- b. Attend conferences/workshops in the relevant areas.
- c. Demonstrate projects/work during the R & D Show case.
- d. Participate in national/international competitions in the related areas.
- e. Develop software/hardware/embedded systems.
- f. Write, publish and present technical papers.
- g. Contribute to open source / community technical development.

Additional Points:

- a. Throughout the two years a student is to work in close guidance with the Honours Adviser. Students should consult their Honours adviser for selection of courses etc. in the 5th through 8th semester.
- b. Upon completion of the summer project(s) with a Pass (P) grade, they will be shown in the final transcript.
- c. For the entire period, a student is expected to work in a single area/research center with a single advisor. This is required to specialize in the respective area.
- d. A 4-yr UG student can withdraw from the Honours programme at the end of 5th semester. Earned honours project credits can be counted only towards open elective credits and not BTP credits. A separate, 2-semester project worth 4 credits have to be completed to satisfy the BTP requirement. Earned summer project credits will not be counted towards graduation requirements or towards BTP or other course/project credits.

Registration Process for Honours Projects:

Students are supposed to register for 2-credit Honours Projects at the beginning of every semester (starting from 5th sem) through IMS. After registering in the course registration page fill the details below in another form (MyIIITH -> Project Registrations -> Edit).

- i) Faculty Name
- ii) Project Type
- iii) Project Title
- iv) Project Description
- v) Objectives (consult the Honours advisor before filling)

Registration Process for Summer Projects:

Honours Students are supposed to register for Summer Projects at the beginning of the respective summer in IMS through the form (MyIIITH -> Summer Project Registration -> Add new). Fill in the details below and get it approved within a week from the respective advisor.

- i) Faculty Name
- ii) Project Type (Summer Project 1 / 2 / 3)
- iii) Project Title
- iv) Project Description
- v) Objectives (consult the Honours advisor before filling)

Evaluation:

- a. All the four Honours projects and summer projects will be monitored and evaluated by the Honours Adviser.
- b. Every Honours/summer project requires the submission of a report within the given timelines. (template given on intranet).

c. Letter grades (P/F for summer projects) will be given by the project advisor at the end of each semester/summer based on the report and overall assessment.

Date: March 2026

**Sd/-
Dean (Academics)**

Timelines for Honors Projects:

Registration	-	1 week before the start of each semester.
Faculty Approval	-	Add/drop courses date of each semester.
Report Submission Due	-	10 th Day after End semester exams.
Grade due from the Advisor	-	2 weeks after End semester exams.

Timelines for Summer projects:

Registration	-	1 week before start of End Exams of Spring semester
Faculty Approval	-	Last day of End exams of Spring semester
Report submission/Grade	-	1 week before start of Monsoon semester.
